Sana Abdul Khaliq, Ph.D.

Biomedical Sciences | Molecular Medicine and Cell Signaling

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Summary

International Biomedical Scientist with advanced training in molecular medicine and cell signaling.

Education

2020-2024 **Ph.D. in Biomedical Sciences**
Gachon University, Incheon, South Korea

2018-2020 **Master of Science (MS) - Biomedical Sciences**
Gachon University, Incheon, South Korea

2013-2017 **Bachelor of Science (BS) - Bioinformatics**
Comsats University Islamabad, Islamabad, Pakistan

Research/ Work Experience

2025-Present **Post-doc Researcher**
Department of Medicine
Karolinska Institutet, Stockholm, Sweden

2024-2025 **Research Professor**
Department of Molecular Medicine
Gachon University, Incheon, South Korea

2018-2024 **Graduate Researcher**
Gachon University, Incheon, South Korea

Honors and awards

Apr 2024	• IUBMB Travel Fellowship award (Biomolecular Horizons 2024, Melbourne, Australia)
2020-2024	• Full-time Ph.D. Scholarship (Gachon University, Incheon, South Korea)
Aug 2023	• Best Poster Award at the Korean Society for Cell Biology Conference (KSCB)
Nov 2021	• Excellent Poster Presentation Award at the International Conference of the Korean Society for Molecular and Cell Biology (KSMCB)
Oct 2020	• Excellent Poster Presentation Award at the International Conference of the Korean Society for Molecular and Cell Biology (KSMCB)
2018-2020	• Full-time MS. Scholarship (Gachon University, Incheon, South Korea)
2013	• Merit based Scholarship (1st Semester, BS. Bioinformatics, COMSATS University, Islamabad, Pakistan)

Featured Research/ Interview

Apr 2025

Hanbista (Korea Biological Research Information Center – BRIC)/Hanbista Interview Series (BRIC)

Featured author for the publication on ARHGEF3 Coordinates Adipocyte Hypertrophy and Differentiation through Dual YAP-RhoA and PPARγ Activation.

https://www.ibric.org/s.do?DTfovIEzYy

Publications

Research and Review Articles:

1. Sun-Hee Cho, Byeongkwon Choi, Jisun Lee, Yu-Sun Lee, Mi-Ock Baek, You-Jeung Lee, Chae-Ok Gil, Min-Kyung Choi, **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Syeda Maham, Jae-Kyung Hyun, Mee-Sup Yoon, et.al, "ApoE deficiency protects from mRNA vaccine-induced mitochondrial dysfunction at the injection site under metabolic stress", Theranostics, Vol.15(17), 2025 (Aug-2025)

2. **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Shi-Young Park, Syeda Maham, Yoonil Cho, Miseon Lee, Seungyoon Nam, Je Kyung Seong, Jie Chen, Cheol-Soo Choi, and Mee-Sup Yoon, "ARHGEF3 Coordinates Adipocyte Hypertrophy and Differentiation through Dual YAP-RhoA and PPARγ Activation", Journal of Advanced Research, 79 (2026) 445-460 (Apr-2025)

3. **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Jaewon Kim, Il-Chan Kim, Jin-Hyoung Kim, Mee-Sup Yoon, "The Extracts from Two Antarctic Fish Species, Trematomus newnesi and Trematomus bernacchii, Enhance JEG-3 Cell Migration and Invasion via MMP9 Activation Through Akt/Protein Phosphatase1/$\boldsymbol{\beta}$-Catenin Pathway", Journal of Molecular Nutrition and Food Research, Vol. 68, 2400028 (2024)

4. Seongmin Lee, Mi-Ock Baek, **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Amna Parveen, Sun Yeou Kim, Jin-Hyoung Kim, Il-Chan Kim, Mee-Sup Yoon, "Antarctic Krill Extracts Enhance Muscle Regeneration and Muscle Function via Mammalian Target of Rapamycin Regulation", Journal of Functional Foods, Vol. 103, 105483 (2023)

5. **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Zoobia Umair, Mee-Sup Yoon, "Role of ARHGEF3 as a GEF and mTORC2 Regulator", Frontiers in Cell and Developmental Biology, Vol. 9, Page. 806258, (2022)

6. **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Zoobia Umair, Mi-Ock Baek, Seung Joo Chon, Mee-Sup Yoon, "C-peptide Promotes Cell Migration by Controlling Matrix Metallopeptidase-9 Activity through Direct Regulation of b-Catenin in Human Endometrial Stromal Cells", Front Cell Dev Biol, Vol. 10, Page. 800181 (2022)

7. **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Mi-Ock Baek, Hye-Jeong Cho, Seung Joo Chon, Mee-Sup Yoon, "C-peptide Inhibits Decidualization in Human Endometrial Stromal Cells via GSK3b-PP1", Front Cell Dev Biol, Vol. 8, Page. 609551 (2020)

8. Kunwoo Kim, Hye-Jeong Cho, **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Kuk Hui Son, Mee-Sup Yoon, "Comparative Analyses of mTOR/Akt and Muscle Atrophy-Related Signaling in Aged Respiratory and Gastrocnemius Muscles", Int J Mol Sci 2020 Vol. 21, Page. 21082862 (2020). (Co-first author).

9. Hye-Jeong Cho, Mi-Ock Baek, **Sana Abdul Khaliq**, Seung Joo Chon, Kuk Hui Son, Sung Ho Lee, Mee-Sup Yoon, "Microgravity Inhibits Decidualization via Decreasing Akt Activity and FOXO3a Expression in Human Endometrial Stromal Cells", Scientific Reports, Vol. 9, Page. 48580 (2019)

Patent:

- Certificate of patent for the article "C-Peptide Promotes Cell Migration by Controlling Matrix Metallopeptidase-9 Activity Through Direct Regulation of β-Catenin in Human Endometrial Stromal Cells."
  Patent number: 10-2640230

Presentation as a Young Scientist

Sept 2023 — 9th AFLAS Congress, Young Scientist Camp, ICC Jeju, South Korea. (Oral Presentation).

Community service

2013-2014 — **British Council**
Active Citizen, Islamabad Pakistan, Various social action projects